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POA 202505-016

May 20, 2025

Susan Cohn
Grants Officer
U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Educational & Cultural Affairs
Executive Office, Grants Division (ECA/EX/G)

Dear Susan,

I hope this message finds you well. We greatly appreciate your continued support for the Education and Culture Program and commitment to people-to-people exchanges and community-led initiatives.

Partners of the Americas (POA) is requesting a change to our Traditional Public-Private Partnership Education and Culture Program (E&C) FY24 award (S-ECAGD-24-GR-0525) to shift the project scope, extend the timeline, and adjust the budget. These proposed changes will allow us to maintain the quality and impact of the project while staying responsive to real-time changes and opportunities. We are committed to delivering on our shared goals and ensuring complete transparency throughout this process.

Background:
The current award for the Education and Culture Program (FY24) was awarded on August 23, 2025, and is set to end on January 31, 2026. The initial proposal submitted to ECA was for $367,110. However, due to funding cuts unrelated to performance, the award was reduced by $18,355, bringing the total to $348,755. At that time, the original proposed targets were not adjusted to align with the new total. During the first five months of the award, POA developed new materials and launched two funding competitions set to close in March 2025. In February 2025, POA removed the live funding opportunities to ensure the Program complies with the new administration's priorities.

Proposed Modification(s):

1. **<u>Program Scope</u>**:

- Number of Exchange Participants:
  Due to the reduction in funding for this award as well as the implementation of group exchanges, which requires more funding, POA is requesting a reduction in the number of exchange participants to ensure adequate funding is available for all participants and associated costs. Additionally, POA is

proposing to reduce the number of community project funding awards to prioritize funding for exchanges. While the number of projects and participants has decreased, the opportunity to engage in cross-regional group exchange will provide quality impact on networks, problem-solving, knowledge sharing, linguistic practice, and other professional skill development. The proposed change is the following:

- Number of Group Exchange Facilitation Funding Awards: Two instead of four.
- Number of Exchange Participants: 24 exchange participants instead of 30.
- Number of Community Project Funding Awards: Four community projects instead of six.

2. **No-Cost Extension:**
Due to the changing priorities from the new administration regarding thematic areas and the halt in disbursements, POA had to remove live opportunities to ensure thematic alignment and funding availability before issuing grants. Adding additional time to the award will ensure that all funding opportunities represent priority areas.
   - Modify the current end date of January 31, 2026, to April 30, 2026.

3. **Budget Modification:**
To ensure compliance with USC travel guidelines, such as the Fly America Act, and using certified travel agencies, POA proposes to manage the acquisition of airline tickets directly. To achieve this, POA is reallocating funds from the contractual to the travel line item. Additionally, the personnel line item is increased to provide staffing support until the new proposed end date of April 30, 2026. (Annex B: Modified Budget Narrative)

Budget Categories		Original Budget	Changes	Revised Budget
1.	Personnel	$85,255	$19,584	$104,839
2.	Fringe Benefits	$22,460	$2,941	$25,401
3.	Travel	$25,749	$52,927	$78,676
4.	Equipment	---	---	---
5.	Supplies	---	---	---
6.	Contractual	$128,000	-$73,000	$55,000
7.	Construction	---	---	---

8.	Other Direct Costs	$10,406	-$2,453	$7,953
9.	Total Direct Costs (lines 1-8)	$271,870	$0.00	$271,870
10.	Indirect Costs	$76,885	$0.00	$76,885
11.	U.S. Share of Costs (lines 9-10)	$348,755	$0.00	$348,755
12.	Recipient Share of Costs	$127,826	$127,826	$127,826
13.	Total Costs (lines 11-12)	$476,581	$476,581	$476,581

Attached, please find the following documents:

- Annex A: Modified Budget Summary (.xlsx)
- Annex B: Modified Budget Narrative
- Annex C: Modified Workplan

Please let us know if you'd like to discuss these proposed changes in more detail—we are happy to provide supporting documentation or answer any questions you may have.

Thank you again for your invaluable support and understanding.

Warm regards,

John McPhail
President and CEO